Golf Monkey: The Case for a Redesign

Oct 27, 2026 · @Christian Gibson

Why I'm writing this

Bob, Golf Monkey has everything a brand needs to take off: a real pro, a real personality, and a name people remember. I'm writing this because I want it to get off the ground, and right now I think the website could quietly hold it back.

Some of what follows is blunt. That's on purpose. A launch that looks unfinished can be dead on arrival, and nobody tells you why. They just don't come back. I'd rather say it now, while it's cheap to fix, than watch good work get ignored.

None of this is about the idea. The tuxedo monkey, your voice and your stories are the best parts, and I kept every one of them. What I changed is how much the site asks of a stranger before they trust it.

What the research says

People judge a website in a fraction of a second, they judge it mostly on looks, and they trust a brand less the moment it feels AI-made. Four findings back this up.

Finding	Study	What it means for Golf Monkey
Visitors form an opinion of a page's look in about 50 milliseconds, and it matches what they think after looking longer.	Lindgaard et al., Carleton University (2006)	The first screen does most of the selling.
46% of people judged a site's credibility partly on its overall design, more than any other factor.	Stanford Web Credibility study, 2,684 people (2002)	If the site looks unfinished, the business looks unfinished.

Finding	Study	What it means for Golf Monkey
Visually complex pages are rated less appealing, even when the layout is familiar. Simple, expected layouts win first impressions.	Google Research, Tuch et al. (2012)	Every extra line, label and tagline costs attention.
When readers suspected content was AI-made, their trust dropped by nearly half, and purchase consideration for nearby ads fell 14%.	Raptive, 3,000 US adults (July 2025)	Looking AI-made has a measurable cost, whether or not it was.
When people notice AI in a brand's marketing, 31% trust the brand less and only 7% trust it more.	Klaviyo and Datalily, 8,000 consumers (Dec 2025)	AI tells are four times more likely to hurt than help.

The Raptive finding matters most here. The drop happened based on what readers *believed*, not on whether the content was actually AI-made. A site only has to look AI-built to pay that price.

A website's job is to get people where they're going

A web designer's job is to get information to people in the most natural, efficient way possible. Everything on a page either helps a visitor find what they came for or gets in their way.

The golf course theme gets in the way. Walking a site hole by hole, with a scorecard that ticks off the pages you've visited, feels like the GeoCities sites of the late '90s, back when the web was a place people went to wander. Those sites were left behind for a reason. Nobody hangs out on the web anymore. People open a website to get something: book a lesson, check a price, buy a hat, find a phone number. Then they leave.

Measured against that, the current site is all over the place. Lessons, merch, the podcast, the tour, the university and the Shoe Bet all get equal weight as nine holes, so nothing tells a visitor where to start. There's no concrete path from "who is this?" to "book a lesson." The site asks visitors to learn its game before it helps them, which tells me nobody designed it with the visitor in mind.

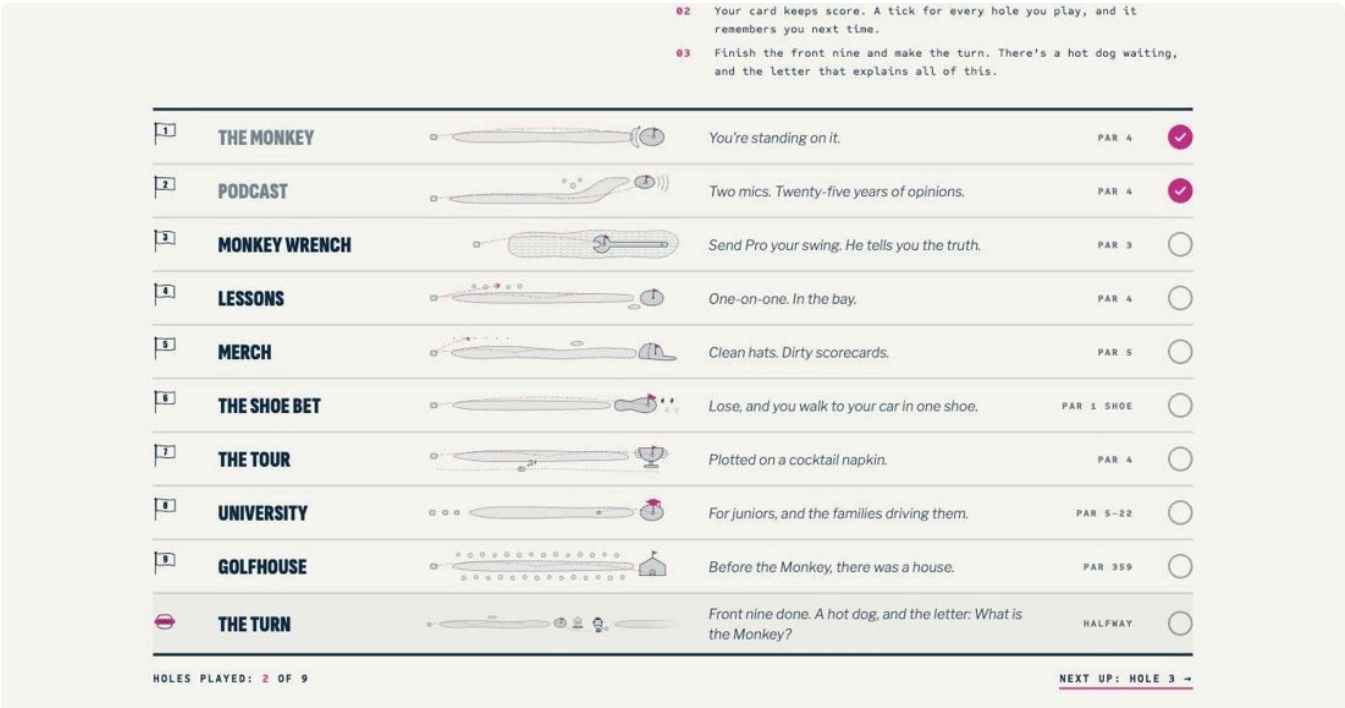
That's also why it reads as AI-made. Generated sites lean hard on one gimmick and stamp the same template everywhere, because repeating is cheap. Here, nearly every hole ends with the same block: a big title, "Turn on volume," a pink "Pause" bar and a quote.



A good site does the opposite. It gives visitors one clear path, and it builds each page around the one thing someone came there to do.

Too much, all at once

The current design is in your face. Every section is shouting, and a first-time visitor doesn't know where to look.



Take the scorecard on the home page. Each row has a flag, a hole name, an AI-drawn fairway, a tagline, a par number and a checkbox. Above it sit three numbered rules. Every page adds more: dotted lines, tiny monospace captions, "Par 4 · Reachable — go for it," "In his own words, from the Golf Monkey Podcast." Each one is clever. Together, they're noise, and the Google study above found that this kind of visual complexity makes a site less appealing at first glance.

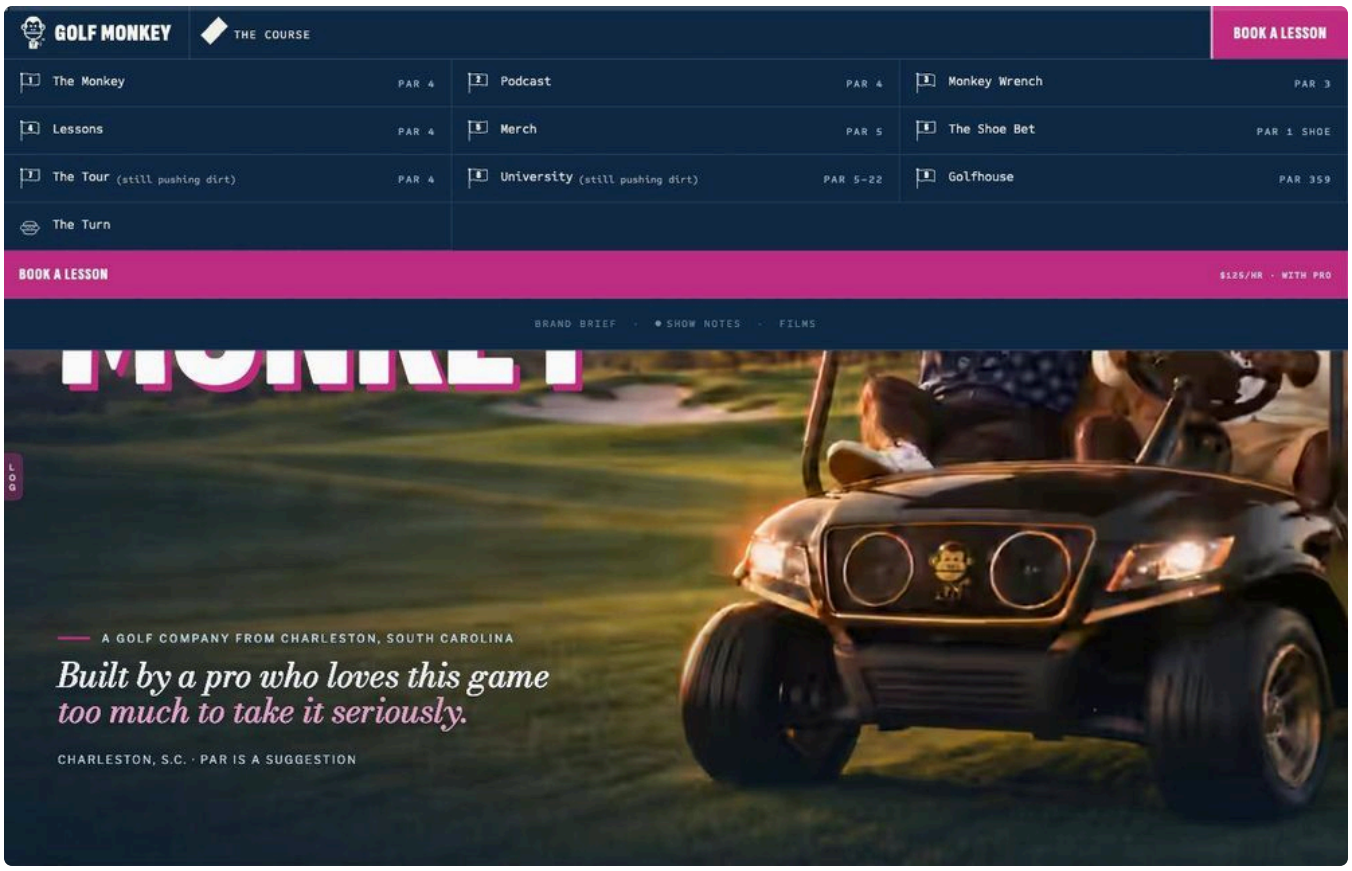
There's a second problem. A lot of those lines are inside jokes: Par 359, "Keep Mrs Pro happy," "Still pushing dirt," the hot dog at the turn. Inside jokes are only funny to the insiders. To a stranger, they read as a language they don't speak yet, and that makes them feel like an outsider on their first visit.

The jokes aren't the problem. The timing is. The best inside jokes in any community aren't written in advance. They come out of the back-and-forth between a host and the audience: a line from an episode that people start repeating, a bet that turns into a tradition, a nickname the regulars give something. That's the sacred part of building a following, and it has to happen on its own. The audience decides which jokes stick.

So the site should leave room for that. Lead with what Golf Monkey is and what you can do for someone. Let the personality show in your voice and your clips. Then, as the audience picks its favorites, those become the inside jokes worth putting on a hat.

Even without a redesign, the interface has to change

If you don't want a full redesign, that's your call. But the interface itself needs work either way, because right now it looks like a freshman's first web design project.



The signs are in the basic building blocks:

- **Navigation that doubles up.** On desktop, a hamburger menu labeled "The Course" drops down over the page, while a full row of hole links already sits right under it. Two menus for the same ten pages means neither one was planned.
- **A hamburger icon where it doesn't belong.** Hamburger menus exist to save space on phones. On a wide desktop screen with plenty of room, it hides navigation that should be visible.
- **Dropdowns hiding content.** The podcast tucks its listening options behind "(and anywhere else you listen to podcasts)" instead of just showing them.
- **Icons doing decoration instead of work.** Every row gets a flag, a hand-drawn fairway, a hot dog or a trophy. None of them helps someone find anything.
- **Pages that don't look like the same site.** The holes, Monkey Wrench, the Hall of Fame and the forfeit certificate each have a different header and a different layout. Monkey Wrench even carries its own "v1 demo" label.

That last point matters most. A site where every page is built differently is a classic sign of AI generation: each page was made in its own prompt, and nobody pulled them together. Visitors won't be able to say what's wrong. They'll just feel it, and as the research above

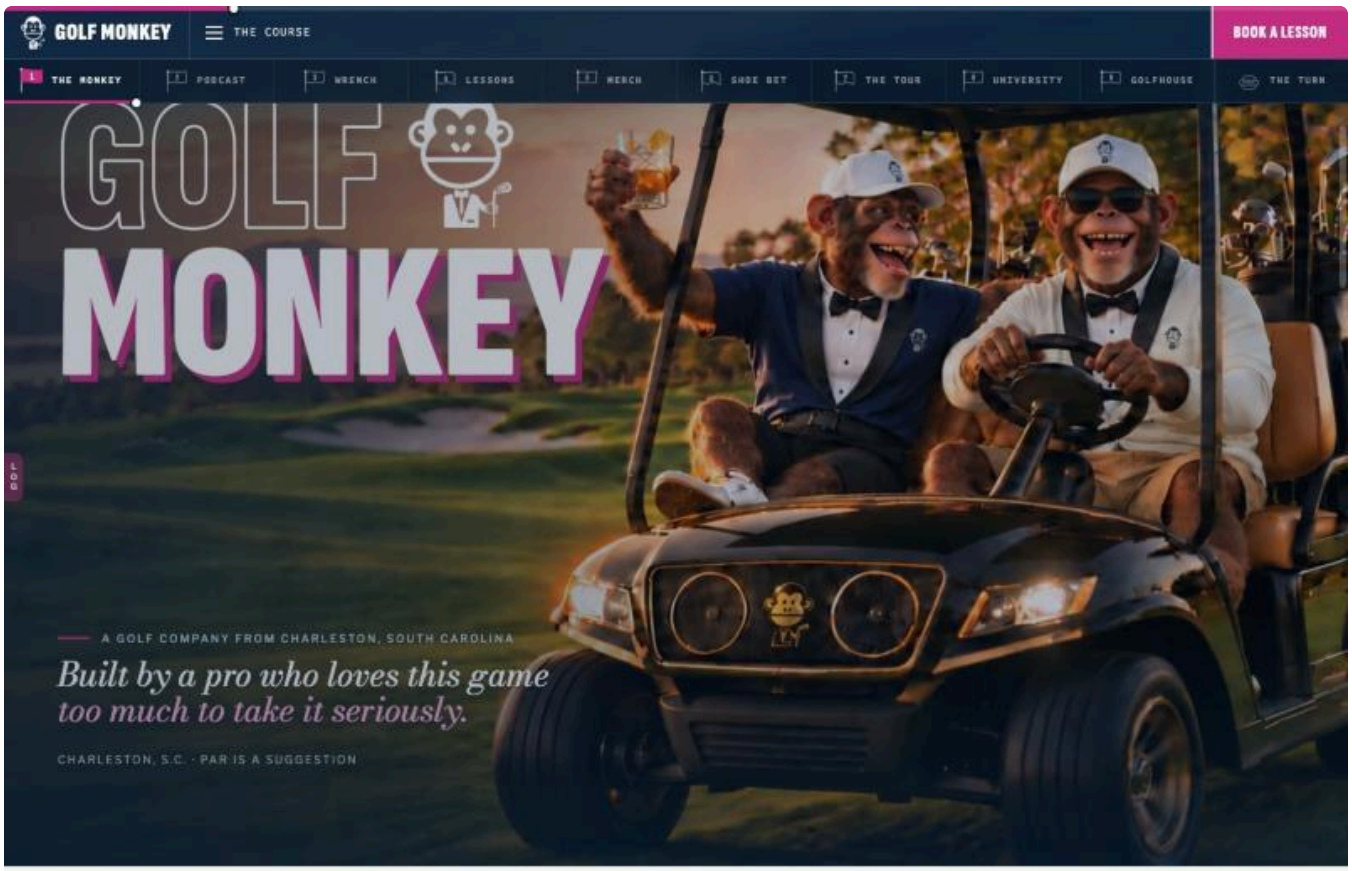
shows, that feeling turns into distrust. People intuitively know something is off, and they leave.

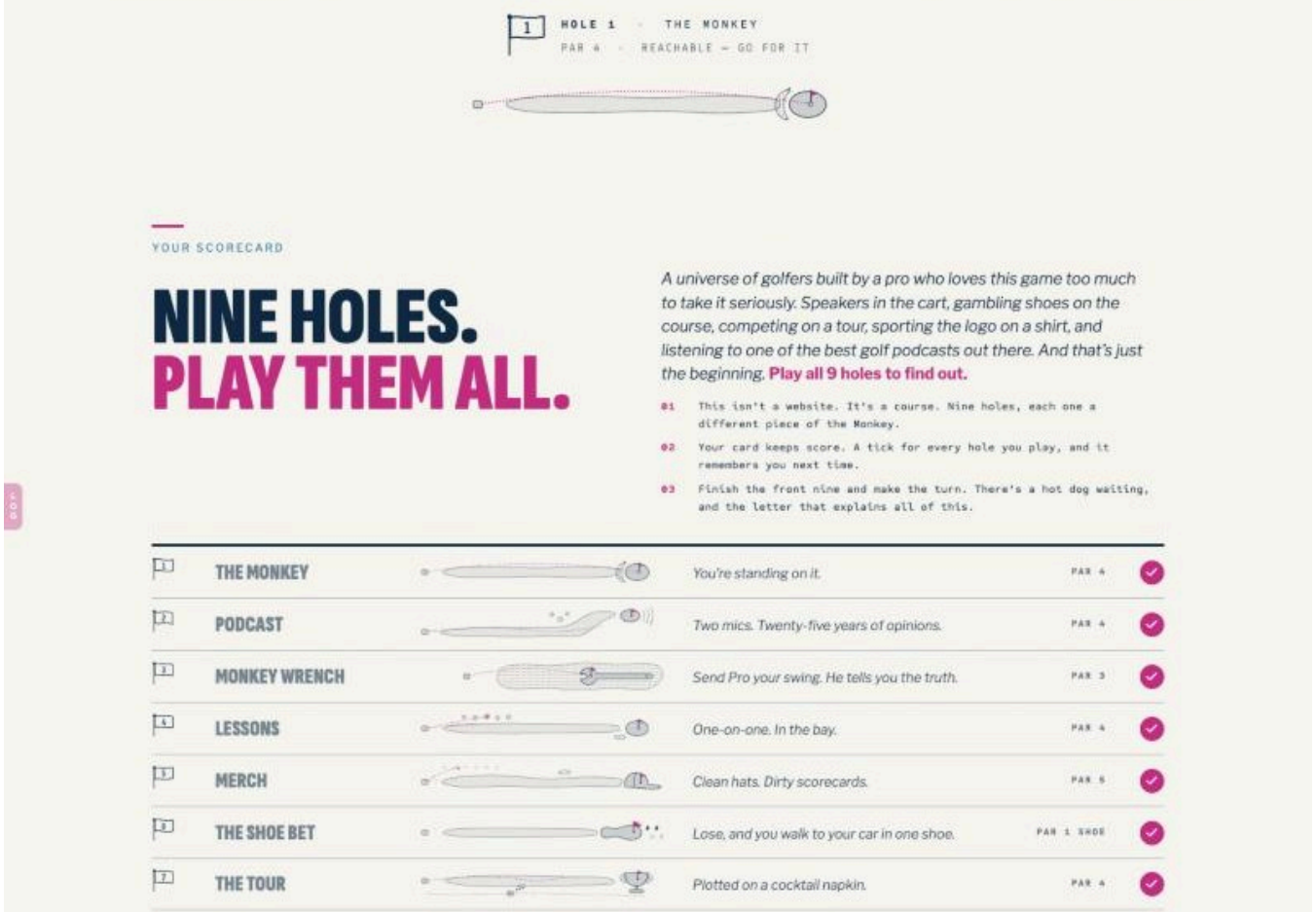
What the redesign changes

The redesign gives visitors a clear path and cuts the clutter, so a stranger knows what Golf Monkey is and how to book within the first screen. Pages are about a third shorter overall, and every page gets a layout built for what it does instead of the same template.

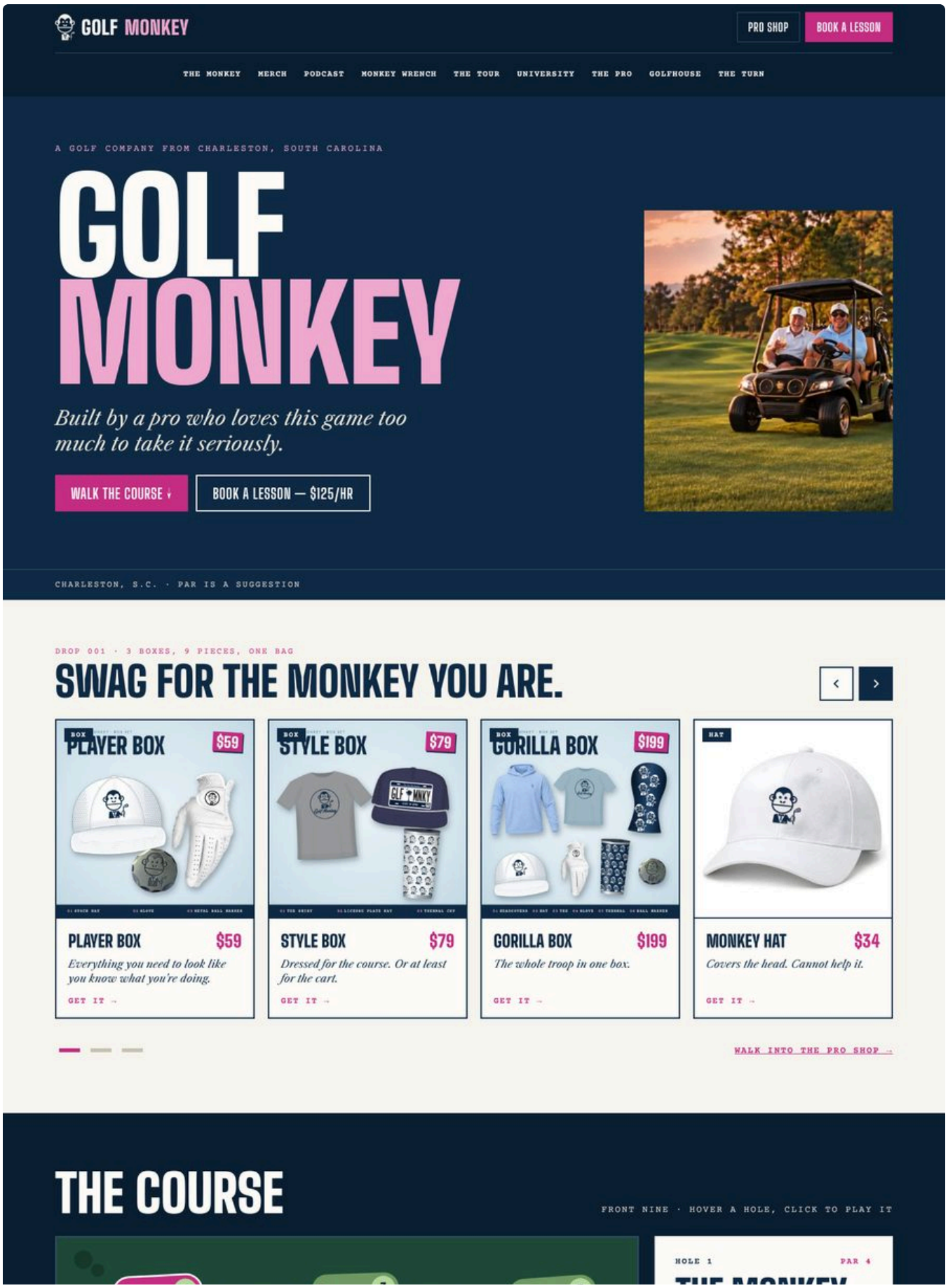
The first screen

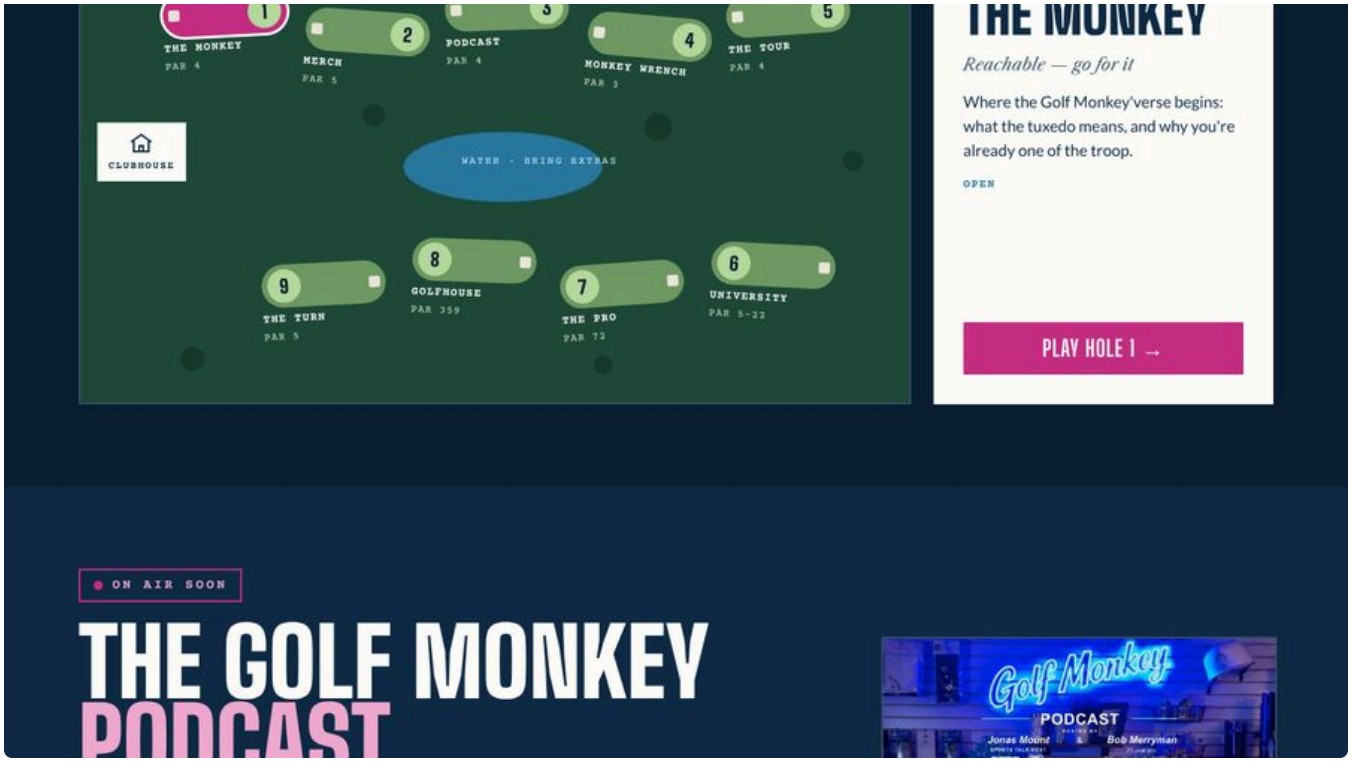
Today, the home page opens on a hero photo and a long scroll animation before a visitor learns that you teach, sell gear or host a podcast. The new home page puts two buttons on the first screen, "Walk the course" and "Book a lesson — $125/hr," then shows the merch, a map of the course and the podcast.


GOLF MONKEY
THE COURSE
BOOK A LESSON
THE MONKEY
PODCAST
WRENCH
LESSONS
MERCH
SHOE BET
THE TOUR
UNIVERSITY
GOLFHOUSE
THE TURN
GOLF
MONKEY
A GOLF COMPANY FROM CHARLESTON, SOUTH CAROLINA
Built by a pro who loves this game too much to take it seriously.
CHARLESTON, S.C. · PAR IS A SUGGESTION


HOLE 1 · THE MONKEY
PAR 4 · REACHABLE — GO FOR IT
YOUR SCORECARD
NINE HOLES.
PLAY THEM ALL.
A universe of golfers built by a pro who loves this game too much to take it seriously. Speakers in the cart, gambling shoes on the course, competing on a tour, sporting the logo on a shirt, and listening to one of the best golf podcasts out there. And that's just the beginning. Play all 9 holes to find out.
01 This isn't a website. It's a course. Nine holes, each one a different piece of the Monkey.
02 Your card keeps score. A tick for every hole you play, and it remembers you next time.
03 Finish the front nine and make the turn. There's a hot dog waiting, and the letter that explains all of this.
THE MONKEY You're standing on it. PAR 4
PODCAST Two mics. Twenty-five years of opinions. PAR 4
MONKEY WRENCH Send Pro your swing. He tells you the truth. PAR 3
LESSONS One-on-one. In the bay. PAR 4
MERCH Clean hats. Dirty scorecards. PAR 5
THE SHOE BET Lose, and you walk to your car in one shoe. PAR 1 SHOE
THE TOUR Plotted on a cocktail napkin. PAR 4

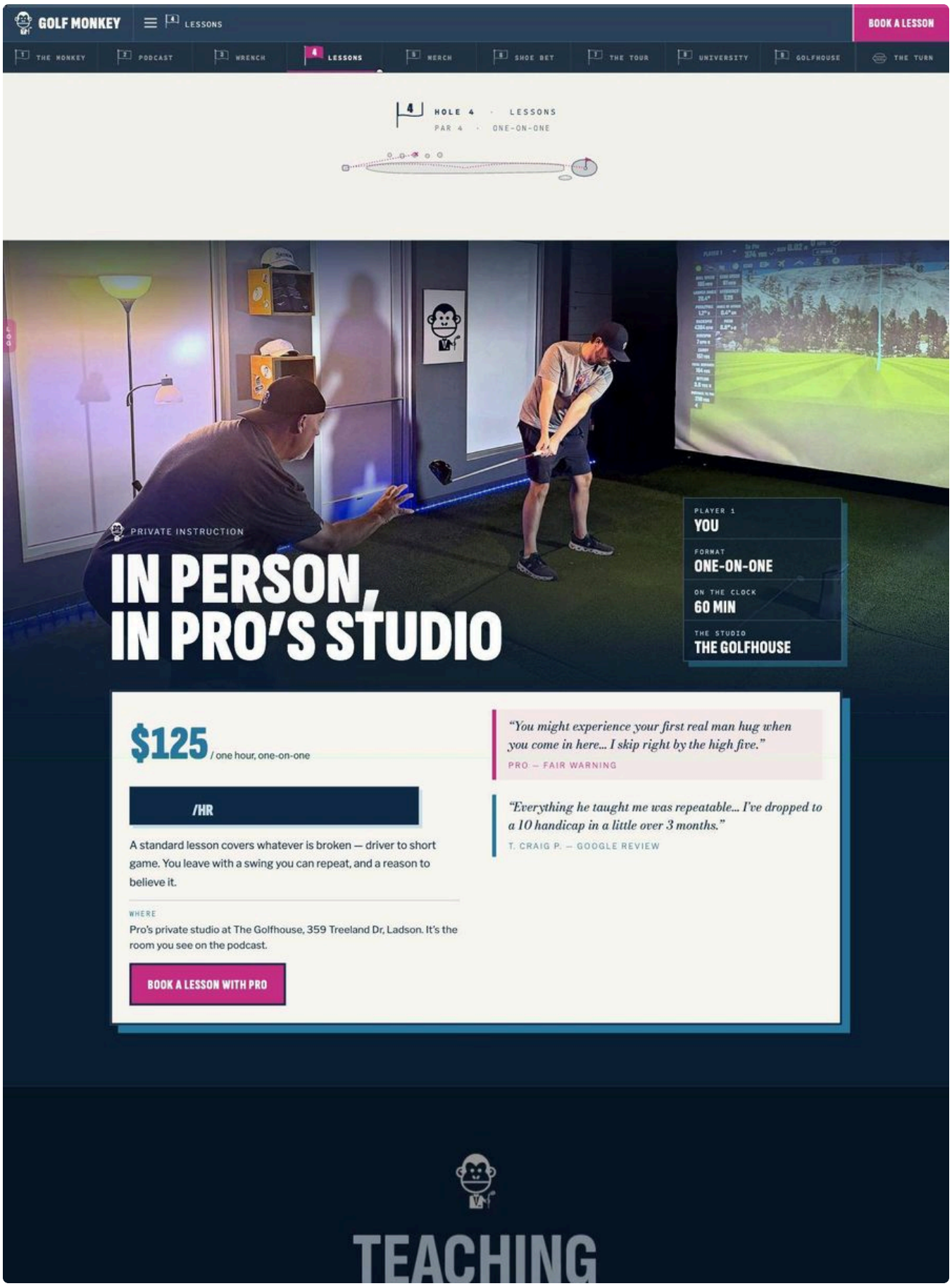

UNIVERSITY
For juniors, and the families driving them.
PAR 5-22
GOLFHOUSE
Before the Monkey, there was a house.
PAR 359
THE TURN
Front nine done. A hot dog, and the letter: What is the Monkey?
HALFWAY
HOLES PLAYED: 9 OF 9 · FRONT NINE DONE.
MAKE THE TURN →
Callaway
Mizuno
Golf Monkey
RESUME
TURN ON VOLUME
"WE TAKE IT SERIOUSLY. HE'S WEARING A TUXEDO. AT THE SAME TIME, IT SHOULD BE FUN."
NEXT TEE · HOLE 2
PODCAST
GOLF MONKEY
Book a lesson — $125/hr
Text the pro — (843) 252-4653
Instagram — @golfmonkeysc
Monkey Wrench
The Pro Shop
Join Drop 001
Charleston, South Carolina
© 2026 Golf Monkey. All lies about handicaps are the member's own.
We're all just monkeys swinging a golf club.


GOLF MONKEY
PRO SHOP
BOOK A LESSON
THE MONKEY
MERCH
PODCAST
MONKEY WRENCH
THE TOUR
UNIVERSITY
THE PRO
GOLFHOUSE
THE TURN
A GOLF COMPANY FROM CHARLESTON, SOUTH CAROLINA
GOLF MONKEY
Built by a pro who loves this game too much to take it seriously.
WALK THE COURSE
BOOK A LESSON — $125/HR
CHARLESTON, S.C. · PAR IS A SUGGESTION
DROP 001 · 3 BOXES, 9 PIECES, ONE BAG
SWAG FOR THE MONKEY YOU ARE.
BOX
PLAYER BOX
$59
PLAYER BOX
$59
Everything you need to look like you know what you're doing.
GET IT →
BOX
STYLE BOX
$79
STYLE BOX
$79
Dressed for the course. Or at least for the cart.
GET IT →
BOX
GORILLA BOX
$199
GORILLA BOX
$199
The whole troop in one box.
GET IT →
HAT
MONKEY HAT
$34
Covers the head. Cannot help it.
GET IT →
WALK INTO THE PRO SHOP →
THE COURSE
FRONT NINE · HOVER A HOLE, CLICK TO PLAY IT
HOLE 1
PAR 4



Booking a lesson

Lessons pay the bills, so booking gets its own page. Today the price sits on the Lessons hole between videos, and the button sends people to Square. The new Book a Lesson page shows private, Monkey Wrench member and junior lessons side by side, with a short form, the studio address and your number to text.


GOLF MONKEY
LESSONS
BOOK A LESSON
THE MONKEY
PODCAST
WRENCH
LESSONS
MERCH
SHOE BET
THE TOUR
UNIVERSITY
GOLFHOUSE
THE TURN
HOLE 4 · LESSONS
PAR 4 · ONE-ON-ONE
PRIVATE INSTRUCTION
IN PERSON,
IN PRO'S STUDIO
PLAYER 1
YOU
FORMAT
ONE-ON-ONE
ON THE CLOCK
60 MIN
THE STUDIO
THE GOLFHOUSE
$125 / one hour, one-on-one
/HR
A standard lesson covers whatever is broken — driver to short game. You leave with a swing you can repeat, and a reason to believe it.
WHERE
Pro's private studio at The Golfhouse, 359 Treeland Dr, Ladson. It's the room you see on the podcast.
BOOK A LESSON WITH PRO
"You might experience your first real man hug when you come in here... I skip right by the high five."
PRO — FAIR WARNING
"Everything he taught me was repeatable... I've dropped to a 10 handicap in a little over 3 months."
T. CRAIG P. — GOOGLE REVIEW
TEACHING

GOLF MONKEY

PRO SHOP | BOOK A LESSON

THE MONKEY | MERCH | PODCAST | MONKEY WRENCH | THE TOUR | UNIVERSITY | THE PRO | GOLFHOUSE | THE TURN

THE LESSON BOOK IS OPEN

BOOK A LESSON.

A standard lesson covers whatever is broken — driver to short game. You leave with a swing you can repeat, and a reason to believe it.

"MY GOAL IS TO GET YOU TO BEAT THE BEST PLAYER IN YOUR FRIEND GROUP."

— PRO



01 · PICK YOUR LESSON

PRIVATE LESSON
$125/HR
One hour, one-on-one, in Pro's dojo.

MONKEY WRENCH MEMBER
$100/HR
The in-person rate for Monkey Wrench subscribers.

JUNIOR LESSON
ASK PRO
Middle school through varsity. Pro will text you the details.

02 · ABOUT YOU

Name | Mobile (Pro texts back) | Email

Handicap (honesty optional)

03 · WHEN & WHAT'S BROKEN

Best time for you: Weekday mornings

What needs work: Driver

Tell Pro what's going on

PRIVATE LESSON · $125/HR

REQUEST MY LESSON →

WHERE

PRO'S DOJO

Pro's private teaching bay at The Golfhouse, 359 Treeland Dr, Ladson. It's the room you see on the podcast.

CAN'T MAKE IT IN?

MONKEY WRENCH · $49/MO

Send Pro your swing. He watches every frame and replies right on the film. Only $49/mo for the first 49 monkeys — and $100/hr in-person lessons after that.

HOW IT WORKS →

OR JUST TEXT THE PRO
(843) 252-4653

"Everything he taught me was repeatable... I've dropped to a 10 handicap in a little over 3 months."

T. CRAIG P. — GOOGLE REVIEW

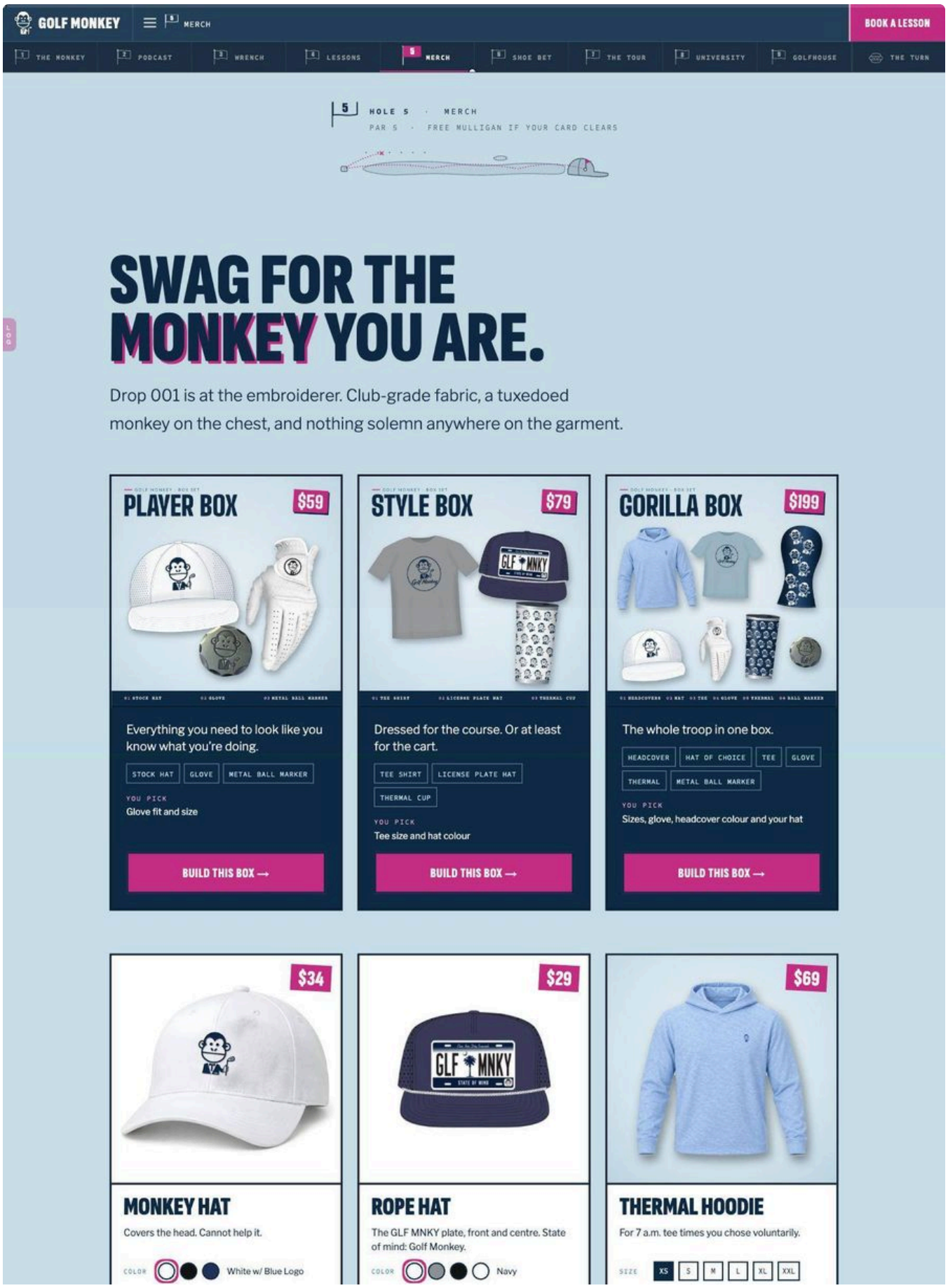
© 2026 Golf Monkey · Charleston, South Carolina

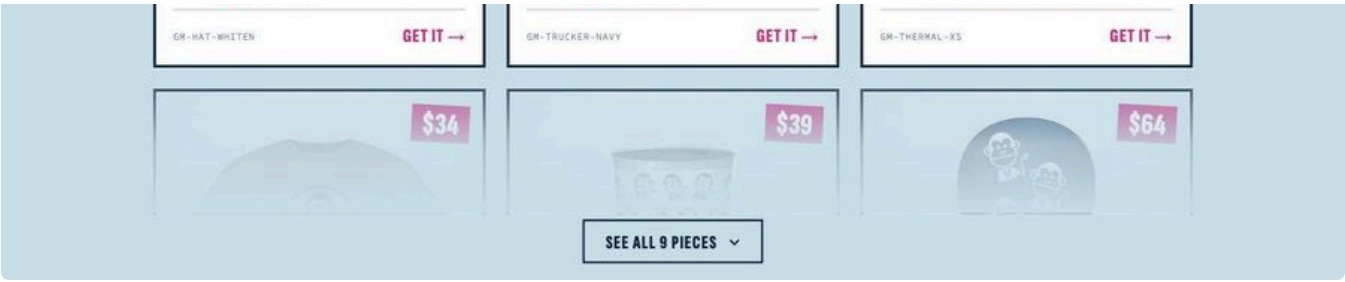
Text the pro — (843) 252-4653

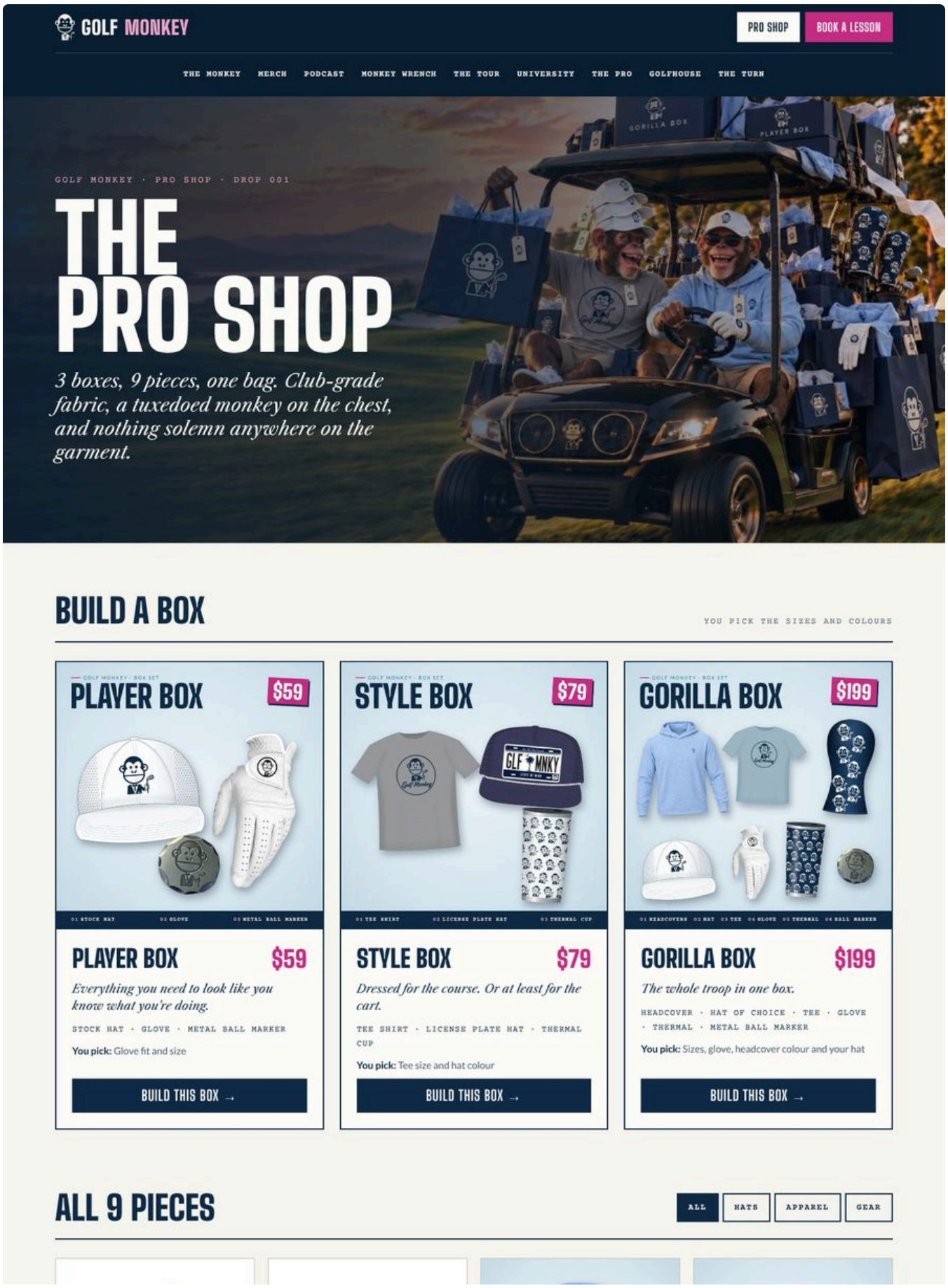
We're all just monkeys swinging a golf club.

The Pro Shop

Drop 001 gets a proper store window. Today the boxes swipe one at a time and share the page with a podcast clip. The new Pro Shop shows all three boxes and all nine pieces at once, with prices, filters and a button on each.


GOLF MONKEY
MERCH
BOOK A LESSON
THE MONKEY
PODCAST
WRENCH
LESSONS
MERCH
SHOE BET
THE TOUR
UNIVERSITY
GOLFHOUSE
THE TURN
HOLE 5 · MERCH
PAR 5 · FREE MULLIGAN IF YOUR CARD CLEARS
SWAG FOR THE MONKEY YOU ARE.
Drop 001 is at the embroiderer. Club-grade fabric, a tuxedoed monkey on the chest, and nothing solemn anywhere on the garment.
PLAYER BOX
$59
Everything you need to look like you know what you're doing.
STOCK HAT
GLOVE
METAL BALL MARKER
YOU PICK
Glove fit and size
BUILD THIS BOX →
STYLE BOX
$79
Dressed for the course. Or at least for the cart.
TEE SHIRT
LICENSE PLATE HAT
THERMAL CUP
YOU PICK
Tee size and hat colour
BUILD THIS BOX →
GORILLA BOX
$199
The whole troop in one box.
HEADCOVER
HAT OF CHOICE
TEE
GLOVE
THERMAL
METAL BALL MARKER
YOU PICK
Sizes, glove, headcover colour and your hat
BUILD THIS BOX →
$34
MONKEY HAT
Covers the head. Cannot help it.
COLOR
White w/ Blue Logo
$29
ROPE HAT
The GLF MNKY plate, front and centre. State of mind: Golf Monkey.
COLOR
Navy
$69
THERMAL HOODIE
For 7 a.m. tee times you chose voluntarily.
SIZE
XS
S
M
L
XL
XXL


GM-HAT-WHITEN
GET IT →
GM-TRUCKER-NAVY
GET IT →
GM-THERMAL-XS
GET IT →
$34
$39
$64
SEE ALL 9 PIECES


GOLF MONKEY
PRO SHOP
BOOK A LESSON
THE MONKEY
MERCH
PODCAST
MONKEY WRENCH
THE TOUR
UNIVERSITY
THE PRO
GOLFHOUSE
THE TURN
GOLF MONKEY · PRO SHOP · DROP 001
THE PRO SHOP
3 boxes, 9 pieces, one bag. Club-grade fabric, a tuxedoed monkey on the chest, and nothing solemn anywhere on the garment.
BUILD A BOX
YOU PICK THE SIZES AND COLOURS
PLAYER BOX
$59
STYLE BOX
$79
GORILLA BOX
$199
Everything you need to look like you know what you're doing.
STOCK HAT · GLOVE · METAL BALL MARKER
You pick: Glove fit and size
BUILD THIS BOX →
Dressed for the course. Or at least for the cart.
TEE SHIRT · LICENSE PLATE HAT · THERMAL CUP
You pick: Tee size and hat colour
BUILD THIS BOX →
The whole troop in one box.
HEADCOVER · HAT OF CHOICE · TEE · GLOVE · THERMAL · METAL BALL MARKER
You pick: Sizes, glove, headcover colour and your hat
BUILD THIS BOX →
ALL 9 PIECES
ALL
HATS
APPAREL
GEAR



MONKEY HAT $34

Covers the head. Cannot help it.

WHITE W/ BLUE LOGO · GM-HAT-WHITEN

GET IT →



ROPE HAT $29

The GLF MNKY plate, front and centre. State of mind: Golf Monkey.

NAVY · GM-TRUCKER-NAVY

GET IT →



THERMAL HOODIE $69

For 7 a.m. tee times you chose voluntarily.

XS–XXL · GM-THERMAL

GET IT →



GOLF MONKEY TEE $34

The crest in navy across the chest. Dress code approved almost nowhere.

HEATHER GREY · XS–XXL · GM-TEE

GET IT →



THERMAL CUP $39

Stainless, covered in tuxedos, for whatever you're drinking on the back nine.

WHITE · GM-CUP-WHITE

GET IT →



DRIVER HEADCOVER $64

A whole troop on it. Fairway and putter covers coming soon.

NAVY · GM-HC-DR-NAVY

GET IT →



CABRETTA GLOVE $24

Premium Cabretta leather, with the Monkey on the tab.

REGULAR / CADET · XS–XXL · GM-GLV

GET IT →



METAL BALL MARK $9

Antique nickel, the Monkey raised on both sides. Heavy enough to mean it.

ONE SIZE · GM-MARK

GET IT →



POKER CHIP $4

Mark your ball with it, or settle the bet with it.

ONE SIZE · GM-CHIP

GET IT →

INDEPENDENT ON PURPOSE

"YOU CANNOT BE CORPORATE AND COOL AT THE SAME TIME."

— Pro, on the podcast

SHOP.GOLFMONKEYSC.COM →



Everything else

- **Navigation:** a header with Pro Shop and Book a Lesson always visible, plus a row of the holes so people can jump straight to one.
- **Your story:** your career moves out of a sideways carousel into its own page, The Pro, laid out as a scorecard.
- **Length:** about 50 laptop screens of scrolling to see every page today, about 34 in the new version, even with two new pages.

What stays the same

Everything that makes it Golf Monkey stays. This is the same brand, made easier to walk into.

- **A little golf.** The flavor lives on in page names and the "Next tee" link at the bottom of each page, but the menu works like any other website. Nobody has to play a game to find the booking page.
- **The monkey.** Same tuxedo, same midnight, fuchsia and powder blue, same type from the brand brief.
- **Your voice.** Every quote and video clip is still there, including "We take it seriously. He's wearing a tuxedo. At the same time, it should be fun."
- **The jokes.** They're still there too, just not stacked on the first screen. As the audience picks its favorites, those get the spotlight.

Next step

The new version is already built, so the ask is small: 20 minutes to walk through it together. You click around, tell me what to change, and I make those changes before anything goes live. The address stays golfmonkeysc.com.

I'm putting this much into the case because I want Golf Monkey to launch strong. You only get one first impression with each new visitor, and I'd like that first impression to make them want to book.

Sources

- Nature News: Lindgaard et al., web users judge sites in 50 milliseconds (2006)
- Stanford Web Credibility study, B.J. Fogg and Consumer WebWatch (2002)
- Google Research: users love simple and familiar designs (2012)
- Raptive study: suspected AI content cuts reader trust by about half (2025)
- eMarketer on Klaviyo and Datalily: visible AI in marketing and brand trust (2026)

Screenshots of the live site were taken on October 27, 2026.